

# TENTACLED TERROR

## CAMEROCERAS

**Cameroceras** has long been a mystery to scientists. Very little is known about this creature because only small portions of its shell have survived, fossilized in very ancient rocks. However, paleontologists have begun to work out details of its biology and lifestyle by comparing it to its modern-day relatives, such as octopuses, cuttlefish, and squid. *Cameroceras* had a strong shell that would have protected most of its body from attack while it grappled with its prey with its muscular tentacles. This creature propelled itself by sucking in water and then expelling it with force.

Shieldlike plates protected the head of *Sacabambaspis*, a jawless fish that existed at the same time as *Cameroceras*.

*Cameroceras*'s tentacles may have grown out of the base of its head, much like the tentacles of modern cuttlefish.

### STATS AND FACTS

*Cameroceras* is known from very few fossil remains. In the past, scientists often lumped together fossils of many similar creatures and labeled them as *Cameroceras*. Further research helped them pinpoint the fossils that truly belong to *Cameroceras*, providing a better understanding of the creature.

#### SHELL LENGTH



Based on some shell fossils, scientists think *Cameroceras*'s shell was up to 20 ft (6 m) in length.

#### STAYING AFLOAT



*Cameroceras*'s shell had chambers that were filled with air, which kept the creature afloat.